

PROMISING RETURN PRACTICES

POST-RETURN NIGERIA

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Name of practice	Post-return policies	
Dates	(No Information)	
Target group	Returnees	
Geographic Scope	Country	Nigeria
	Regions	Africa
	Sub Region	West Africa
Actor	Patriotic Citizen Initiative	
Return Stages	Post-Return	
Challenge addressed	Governance, Cooperation and Coordination Reintegration Sustainability	
Principles referred (implicit or explicit)	Vulnerability & child-centred approach Human-rights-based approach	

SUMMARY

Patriotic Citizen Initiatives collaborates with the National Commission for Refugees, Migrants and Internally Displaced Persons (NCFRMI), IOM, and other CSOs through Nigeria's National Referral Mechanism to provide psychosocial counselling, vocational training, and long-term monitoring of returnees in Lagos (South West) and Benin City (South South).

Working with the International Labour Organization (ILO), PCI provides training and capacity-building for returnees, particularly those assisted by IOM. These programmes equip migrants with market-relevant skills and viable business ideas, helping them adapt to Nigeria's challenging economic conditions and avoid re-trafficking or renewed irregular migration.

BENEFITS/IMPACTS AND SHORTCOMINGS

PCI strengthens Nigeria's migration governance by integrating psychosocial support, protection, and economic empowerment for returnees. Through collaboration with NCFRMI, IOM, NAPTIP, and civil society networks, PCI provides counselling, vocational training, and family reintegration, while specialised profiling ensures trafficked persons receive tailored support. Partnerships with the ILO equip returnees with practical skills and viable business ideas that foster economic independence. These efforts improve mental health, reduce stigma, lower risks of re-trafficking and irregular migration, and anchor reintegration in local communities. At the institutional level, PCI's work reinforces national coordination mechanisms and makes reintegration processes more humane, sustainable, and resilient.

KEY LESSONS

Multistakeholder support is fundamental for successful returnee integration. While challenges of sustainability and scale remain, the practice identified above shows that attention to migrants' vulnerabilities before return, coupled with holistic, community-anchored reintegration afterwards, can significantly reduce risks of re-trafficking, stigma, and irregular re-migration. The practice also underscores the importance of linking return and reintegration to broader employment creation and development policies.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Adopt holistic and sustainable reintegration approaches. Reintegration is most effective when it combines psychosocial support, protection for trafficked persons, and economic empowerment. In Nigeria, civil society organisations like PCI should be supported for their grassroots role, while the National Referral Mechanism must be strengthened to ensure consistent services across regions.

Expand skills development and community engagement. Vocational training and entrepreneurship programs are essential to reduce re-trafficking and irregular migration. Reintegration strategies should actively involve families and communities to counter stigma, and long-term monitoring systems should track outcomes to measure effectiveness.

Strengthen coordination and regional cooperation. Effective reintegration benefits from robust cross-border collaboration. In Nigeria, stronger regional engagement within ECOWAS and with international partners would improve protection, referrals, and coordination for returnees.

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